

English Technical Reports

Lectures Prepared By

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The semester Schedule

Fourth Semester											
1	BSC203	Technical Reporting	تقارير فنية باللغة الإنجليزية	2	2	3	60	40	100	2	
2	ENE203	Electrical Wiring and Inspection.	التمديدات والفحوصات الكهربائية	2	3	3	60	40	100	3	ENE103
3	ENE204	Electrical Machines (1)	الآلات كهربائية (1)	2	3	3	60	40	100	3	ENE103
4	ENE205	Energy Economics	اقتصاديات الطاقة	1	3	2	60	40	100	2	
5	ENE206	Measurements and Instrumentation Technology	القياسات و تكنولوجيا أجهزة القياس	2	3	3	60	40	100	3	ENE103
6	ENE207	Fundamentals of Microcontroller	أساسيات المعالجات الدقيقة	2	3	3	60	40	100	3	
7	BSC204	Driving skills	مهارات القيادة	1	0	1	100	0	100	2	
Total				12	17	18	500	200	700		
	ENE 290	Cooperative work experience	تدريب عملي (1)	0	30	3	0	100	100	---	---

Syllabus

BSC203	Technical Reporting	تقارير فنية باللغة الإنجليزية	2	2	3
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The course provides students with indispensable knowledge and skills to be able to write professional and scientific reports that conform to conventional formats and communicate their message as effectively and efficiently as possible to all stakeholders and/or decision makers. Good report-writing skills have become essential for managers and employees, and this course specifically looks into various report types that require certain research and interpretation methods. Students will also become familiar with the different phases in the report-writing process, the main elements that are usually included in reports and the application of these styles for report writing.

60 Marks Theoretical			40 Marks Tutorial		
30	15	15	20	10	10
Final	Midterm	Quizzes Attending Interaction Sheets Reports Oral	Final	Midterm	Quizzes Attending Interaction Sheets Reports

CONTENTS

Chapter 1	Introduction to Technical Writing
Chapter 2	Technical Report Designing
Chapter 3	Letter Writing
Chapter 4	CV & Resume Writing
Chapter 5	Technical Documents
Chapter 6	Detailed Components of Reports
Chapter 7	Communication Skills
Chapter 8	Presentation and Display

Objectives

- To introduce Technical Reports.

Topics covered

- Course Goals.
- Six Points Tips to Success in Technical Writing.

Introduction to Technical Writing

1.1. Introduction

- Technical writing is a typical form of writing, different from expressive expository or descriptive writing.
- Technical writing requires give and take, dialogue, follow-up, input, and action.
- Most often, it creates action; it causes the person at the other end to react or respond.
- It is also a form of documentation where processes are described, recorded, and analyzed.

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Introduction to Technical Writing

1.1. Introduction

- There are three factors determining technical writing: purpose, audience, and tone.
- If you are writing to someone above you in the hierarchy, you are probably requesting or recommending action.
- But if it is someone below you, you are directing action or instructing.

Introduction to Technical Writing

1.1. Introduction

- Again, if you are writing a report solely for the purpose of documenting, your language will be different.
- But if you are presenting a proposal and trying to convince your colleagues, your tone will have to be persuasive.

Introduction to Technical Writing

1.2. Defining The Objectives

A well-written technical document must define the objectives very specifically at the outset. The writer must be very clear about:

- Why the document is being written.

Is it being written to simply record a process and keep it for reference or is it a proposal or plan which one wants others to accept or is one trying to convince somebody that the proposed plan of action is undesirable or desirable.

Introduction to Technical Writing

- What exactly is the writing intended to do?
- Technical writing is generally written to convey information.
- It can be **aimed at giving the reader** information he/she desired to have, or it can be aimed at changing the readers' response or attitude towards an object, a proposal, or a process.
- Or it can aim at giving the reader a set of instructions as to the operation or working of a machine or gadget.

Introduction to Technical Writing

- What exactly is the writing intended to do?
- If your report is **about the financial feasibility** of changing certain machinery in the company, your highlight should be the cost incurred in maintaining the old machinery and other recurring expenditures.
- The present expense should be compared with the new expense and shown as less.
- The superior quality of the output or the subsequent convenience should also be presented appealingly.

Introduction to Technical Writing

- **What exactly is the writing intended to do?**
- If your communication is **intended to get funding for a project**, your purpose will be to convince your boss or the funding agency about the necessity of this project, to highlight how the organization will benefit from it and how the proposed outcome will fulfill long-term goals and objectives.

Introduction to Technical Writing

- What exactly is the writing intended to do?
- This can be done by presenting the material in the form of:
- **Points and Sub-points:** Presenting the relevant facts as easily accessible points and sub-points.
- **Tables:** Putting the facts you want your readers to compare and contrast in the form of a table.
- **Flow Charts:** If you want your audience to quickly compare the lengths of two processes you could present both in the form of two flow charts on the same page. This will make comparison and assessment easy for the readers.

Introduction to Technical Writing

❖ *The following are some general technical writing tips for success:*

Six Points

- **Be Specific and Avoid Clutter in Your Writing**
 - The secret of good writing is to strip every sentence to its cleanest components.
 - Every word that serves no function, every long word that could be a short word, every adverb which carries the same meaning that is already in the verb, every passive construction that leaves the writer unsure of who is doing what – these are thousand and one adulterants that weaken the strength of a sentence.

Introduction to Technical Writing

Six Points

❖ ***The following are some general technical writing tips for success:***

- **Be Specific and Avoid Clutter in Your Writing**
- ✓ Technical writing is not literary writing, which serves a completely different purpose.
- ✓ Technical writing must be clear and concise.
- ✓ Short declarative sentences are the easiest to write and read, and they are usually clear.
- ✓ However, too many short sentences in a row can sound abrupt and monotonous.
- ✓ Good technical writing involves finding the right mix between short sentences and more complex constructions

Introduction to Technical Writing

Six Points

❖ *The following are some general technical writing tips for success:*

- **Write with an Active Voice**

- An active voice is always preferable to a passive voice.

“The researchers found a strong correlation between the dosage of the drug and its efficacy.”

“A strong correlation between the dosage of the drug and its efficacy was found by the researchers.”

Introduction to Technical Writing

- ❖ **Active voice is especially effective when...**

- You need to establish responsibility. If the responsibility for observations, actions, assumptions, recommendations, or judgments is unclear, readers become confused, and firms may take on liability unintentionally.
- You are emphasizing a client-consultant relationship - we (the engineers) do something that you (the client) wanted.
- Passive voice makes the content hard to follow. Active voice expresses actions in the most direct and concise way, so it is the easiest structure for readers to interpret.

Introduction to Technical Writing

❖ **Passive voice is especially effective when...**

- The agent is unknown or unimportant.
- You have already established the agent and now the receiver of the action is the topic of interest.
- Many descriptions of methods use passive voice effectively after the agent has been stated in an initial active voice sentence.
- Your audience asks you to use passive voice. For example, instructors may ask students to use passive voice in the methods sections of lab reports.

Introduction to Technical Writing

Six Points

❖ *The following are some general technical writing tips for success:*

- **Present Accurate Information and Be as Precise as Possible**
 - The author of a technical paper uses words to relay information about facts and events that have happened.
 - The author typically **does not** relay opinions, **except** in the cases where an unexplained event or phenomenon has occurred.
 - **If this is done**, it is important that the author make *clear that he or she is offering an opinion and not a fact*.

Introduction to Technical Writing

Six Points

❖ ***The following are some general technical writing tips for success:***

- **Use Different Verb Tenses for Different Expository Purposes**
 - The **present** tense can also be used when you are giving your own ideas.
 - **Future** tenses are used *very sparingly* but are more common when writing research proposals.
 - If the author is writing about experiments or activities yet to come, the **future** tense can also be appropriate.

Introduction to Technical Writing

Six Points

- ❖ The following are some general technical writing tips for success:
- Try Using Third-Person Pronouns

PERSONAL PRONOUNS		
	Singular	Plural
First Person	I, me <i>my, mine</i>	we, us <i>our, ours</i>
Second Person	you <i>your, yours</i>	you <i>your, yours</i>
Third Person	he, she, it him, her <i>his, her, hers, its</i>	they, them <i>their, theirs</i>

Introduction to Technical Writing

Six Points

❖ ***The following are some general technical writing tips for success:***

- **Use Charts, Tables, and Graphs**
- Tables and charts are **important** components in technical papers.
- They convey a lot of information **in the shortest time and in minimum space.**
- ✓ Label all charts, tables, and graphs sequentially, and give them titles.
- * *A common mistake* among novice writers is to include tables and graphs **but somehow fail to discuss them in the report.**